

4.5 Camera Phones

A camera phone is a cell phone which has an inbuilt camera. The world's first camera phone was the J-SH04 by Sharp Corporation in Japan in November 2000. The cameras used in cell phones typically use CMOS image sensors. This is due largely to reduced power consumption compared to CCD-type cameras. Major manufacturers include Nokia, Samsung, Motorola, Siemens, Sony Ericsson, and LG Electronics. Typically, a camera in a mobile phone has a range of up to 2 megapixels. Samsung Electronics unveiled the world's first 8-megapixel camera phone, the WCDMA SPH-V8200, but as far sale of camera phones are concerned it is the ones with 2-megapixel cameras that sell.



The popularity of camera phones has far exceeded that of standalone digital cameras. Newer camera phones are also compatible with photo printers, and printouts of the pictures you've taken can be had really fast. As of early 2005, camera phones were already outselling digital cameras by a factor of four.

As a network-connected device, megapixel camera phones are starting to play significant roles in crime prevention, journalism and business applications. On the other hand, they are prone to abuse such as voyeurism and invasion of privacy.

Camera phones have led to the rise in mobile blogging that has